

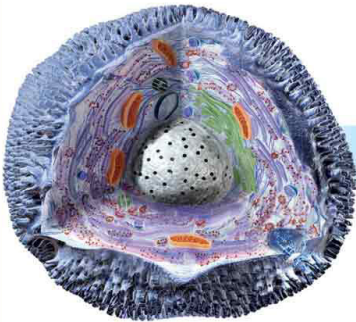
From cells to systems

The 100 trillion cells that make up the body do not operate independently of each other. If they did, the body would be an uncoordinated, shapeless mass. Instead, they are precisely organized to form tissues, organs, and systems that work together to make a complete, functioning human body.

Body organization

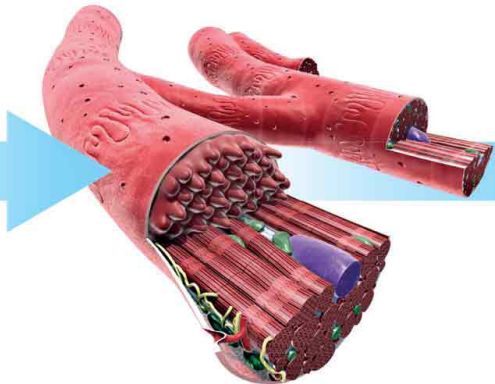
The body is organized as a series of different levels. At the lowest level are cells. Cells work together in groups called tissues. Different tissues are grouped together to produce organs, such as the heart. At the highest and most complex level, organs are linked together to form a system, such as the circulatory, or blood, system.

CELL



This typical **cell** shows the features that are common to all cells. Cardiac muscle cells, with these and other features, are found in the heart. They contract, or shorten, to make the heart beat.

TISSUE



Cells of the same type work together in a group called a **tissue**. Cardiac muscle cells are linked together in a network to form cardiac muscle tissue.